Introduction

திருக்குறள் - Thirukkural

Thirukkural is a classic Tamil text composed by the poet-philosopher Thiruvalluvar, believed to have been written around the 1st century BCE to 5th century CE. It consists of 1,330 short couplets (kurals), organized into 133 chapters, covering three major themes: Aram (virtue), Porul (wealth and governance), and Inbam (love).

This sample knowledge base contains a small curated selection of verses and explanatory notes covering education, virtue, friendship, and wealth, provided for demonstration purposes within the Code Bloom project.

Kalvi (Education) - Chapter 40

அதிகாரம் 40: கல்வி (The Chapter on Education)

Kural 391:
கற்க கசடறக் கற்பவை கற்றபின்
நிற்க அதற்கூத் தக.
Translation (G.U. Pope): 'Learn thoroughly, without flaw, whatever you learn; and having learned, live worthy of your learning.'

Kural 392:
கல்லாதவர் நஞ்சம் கற்றதூ என ஒக்கூம்
நல்லாசான் மொழிந்த கரூத்தூ.
Translation: The mind of the unlearned, seeking to speak as if learned, resembles a mimicry of the wise teacher's true insight.

Explanation: Thiruvalluvar places great emphasis on the importance of thorough education. According to the Kural, true education is not merely accumulating information but internalizing it so completely that one's conduct reflects what has been learned. The teacher (ஆசிரியர்) plays a central role in shaping a learner's character, not just their knowledge - the role of the teacher is to guide the student toward wisdom that is expressed through right action, not simply recited facts.

Kalvi (Education) - Chapter 40 (continued)

Kural 396:
தொட்டனைத் தூறும் மணற்கேணி மாந்தர்க்கூக்
கற்றனைத் தூறும் அறிவு.
Translation: As a sand-well, the more it is dug, yields more water, so the more a person learns, the more their wisdom springs forth.

Explanation: This verse compares knowledge to an underground spring - the more effort one invests in learning, the more insight is revealed. In the context of education, Thiruvalluvar suggests that learning is an active, continuous process rather than a fixed destination. A teacher's role, and a student's own diligence, both contribute to how deep this well of understanding becomes over a lifetime of study.

Aram (Virtue) - Chapter 1: Praise of God

அதிகாரம் 1: கடவுள் வாழ்த்து (Praise of God)

Kural 1:
அகர முதல எழுத்தெல்லாம் ஆதி
பகவன் முதற்றே உலகு.
Translation: As the letter A is the first of all letters, so the eternal God is first in the world.

Explanation: The opening verse of Thirukkural establishes the foundational importance of virtue (aram) by drawing a parallel between the alphabet's first letter and the primacy of moral and spiritual grounding in life. Thiruvalluvar's ethical philosophy is often described as universal and non-sectarian - applicable across faiths and beliefs - focusing on right conduct as the basis of a meaningful life.

Natpu (Friendship) - Chapter 79

அதிகாரம் 79: நட்பு (Friendship)

Kural 781:
சயெற்கரிய யா�உள நட்பின் அதுபோல்
வினை மாட்சி இல்லைப் பிற.
Translation: There is no virtue greater than friendship; nothing else achieves such difficult things as true friendship can.

Explanation: Thiruvalluvar dedicates an entire chapter to the value of genuine friendship, describing it as a relationship built on honesty, mutual correction, and shared growth. A true friend, according to the Kural, is one who points out one's faults for the sake of improvement, not one who simply flatters.

Porul (Wealth) - Chapter 76: The Might of Kings

அதிகாரம் 76: படமொட்சி (The Excellence of an Army / Governance)

Kural 757:
உறுப்பமந் தூறந்த வலெ்படை வந்தேன்
வறுெப்பமயொ வலெ் படை பரிதூ.
Explanation: In the Porul (wealth/polity) section, Thiruvalluvar discusses governance, leadership, and statecraft, describing the qualities of an effective ruler and a well-organized state. These chapters are often studied by scholars researching classical Tamil political philosophy and administration.